The trouble is that the Palestinians also have their irreducible fanatics. They probably will not accept any agreement and strive instead for Israel's disappearance. Edward Said, one of the most prominent of Palestinian voices, was also a diehard of the "refusal front" on the morrow of the Oslo Accords. Oslo, for Said, was "a Palestinian Versailles." Intifada 1 and 2 were the most recent large-scale murderous expressions of Palestinian refusal. On various scales, such murderous initiatives were an integral part of the Palestinian response from the beginning of Zionism. Of course, this says nothing about Palestinian frustration, humiliation, and suffering before, and mainly since, 1967.

Saturday evening (this evening), some 160,000 demonstrators in Tel Aviv, tens of thousands in Haifa, and more than ever in various towns all over the country. And in Tel Aviv they are getting less polite. Good!

Ehud Barak's speech to the crowd in Tel Aviv was particularly important. It expressed again, more forcefully, what he had already ventured beforehand and what led Knesset member Gotliv to demand his arrest: if Netanyahu manages to overturn Israeli democracy, if Israel turns into a full-fledged nationalist-religious dictatorship, the duty of officers, state employees, and others will be to refuse to obey orders. During the last few days, former heads of the Mossad have said the same thing. Unheard of in Israel!

Sunday, February 26

Two youngsters from a settlement shot and killed by a Palestinian terrorist in Huwara, a small town near Nablus, as they were driving through. In response, the cabinet voted the death sentence for terrorists. A Ben-Gvir demand. There was no death sentence in Israel, except for "Nazis and their collaborators." It was applied only once, on Adolf Eichmann.